



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Stonehaven School

School Website: <https://stonehavenschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary

Stonehaven School GA 30060 presents a robust classical Christian orientation across all six classical-evaluation categories. Public-facing materials repeatedly emphasize a Christ-centered, biblical worldview, a formation-focused purpose, a curriculum built on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with Latin, Great Books/primary texts, and an integrated liberal-arts approach, complemented by explicit contemplative pedagogy (scholé-like rest/wonder), ritual-laden community life, and a strong emphasis on parent partnership. The school's mission and communications routinely foreground truth, goodness, and beauty, and explicitly frame education as soul-formation rather than mere information or workforce preparation. Across categories, the positive indicators consistently outpace negative indicators, aligning Stonehaven with CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL profiles.

- Overall classification by category:
  - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
  - Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
  - Curriculum — CLASSICAL
  - Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
  - Faculty — CLASSICAL
  - Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
  - Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL
- Key insights:
  - The school's public materials strongly foreground a Christ-centered Christian worldview, catechesis, liturgical/hymnic practices, and a communal life oriented toward worshipful learning.
  - The curriculum centers on the Trivium, liberal-arts learning, Latin, and engagement with Great Books/primary texts, with explicit history instruction in a unified, interwoven manner rather than siloed "social studies."
  - Pedagogical methods emphasize memory-rituals in the lower grades (singing/chanting/memorization) and rhetoric, logic, and oral-argument work in the upper grades, which aligns with classical pedagogy expectations.
  - The faculty presentation, student-teacher relationships, and explicit parent-partnership language reinforce a living-curriculum model and a community-centered classical ethos.
  - What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases only): None required here, as all six categories meet CLASSICAL criteria.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's core mission states it exists "to glorify God by cultivating truth, goodness, and beauty in students through a distinctly Christ-centered classical education." - A foundational commitment

is a Christian Worldview, with emphasis on biblical truth as foundational to all education. - Public materials describe education as soulcraft and emphasize catechesis and liturgy as integral to daily learning. - Communal rituals/lighting and worship-like practices appear in references to Christian rituals, liturgies, and gospel-centric formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, biblical truth, Christian worldview, catechesis, liturgy, gospel, truth, wonder, worship, reverence. - Examples: "Christ-centered classical education," "glorify God by cultivating truth, goodness, and beauty," "biblical truth," "catechesis," "liturgies," "Truth of the Gospel." - Negative keywords present: Occasional critique of modern education (e.g., "modern ill," "chronological snobbery") as a foil to classical aims, which functions as a contextual counterpoint rather than a negation of religious foundations.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds transcendentals in a Christian framework (truth, goodness, beauty), explicit theology/theology-infused pedagogy, liturgical practices, and catechetical formation, which strongly aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.

## **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The stated goal is formation and virtue: "The goal of education is the formation of young people of faith and virtue," not vocational preparation. - The mission explicitly emphasizes glorifying God and cultivating truth, goodness, and beauty, framing education as formation and human flourishing rather than job-training. - The articulation of wedging education into virtues and a moral telos (Truth, Goodness, Beauty; soul craft) is central to communications.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, great conversation, moral imagination, truth, goodness, beauty, soul craft. - Examples: formation, virtue, truth, beauty, telos, great conversation, soul craft. - Negative keywords present: references to "college admissions" or "career readiness" are explicitly rejected as primary goals, signaling a focus beyond workforce preparation.

Why this rating - The school emphasizes formation, virtue, and a transcendent telos with a classical mission, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for the School Purpose and Goal.

## **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The Trivium is central: training in grammar, logic, and rhetoric. - Latin is a core subject; classical languages are emphasized. - Great Books/primary texts and the Great Conversation are evidenced by Upper School Essentials (e.g., *The Giver*, *Tartuffe*, *Much Ado About Nothing*, *Frankenstein*, *Little Women*). - History taught throughout the curriculum; four-year history cycling is noted; integration across disciplines with a liberal-arts focus. - The Lower School emphasizes memorization via chant, songs, and rhythm; D.E.A.R. Day; and a grammar-stage approach aligned with the Trivium. - Nature Studies, Earth Science, and a broad liberal-arts approach (history, literature, science, mathematics) show interdisciplinary, integrated progression.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium; Quadrivium), grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, history across curriculum, classic texts, primary sources, nature studies, awe/wonder, integration. - Examples: Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; history; nature studies; interconnected disciplines. - Negative keywords present: minimal in public articulation; some mention of "project-based learning dominance" in the lexicon, but Stonehaven's materials emphasize classical methods over purely project-based approaches.

Why this rating - The curriculum aligns with the Seven Liberal Arts framework, a strong Great-Books orientation, extensive use of Latin, and an integrated history-literature-science approach—core CLASSICAL indicators.

**Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Lower School pedagogy emphasizes contemplative/restful elements, memory work, singing, and chanting to deepen memory and delight. - The Lower School uses singing/recitation as a primary memory tool; a memorization-forward approach is highlighted. - Upper School pedagogy emphasizes thinking, communicating, and loving; rhetoric and public speaking are trained in later grades (tenth–twelfth). - The Trivium framework guides pedagogy across grades; the school emphasizes the development of logical thinking and persuasive communication in the upper grades. - There are explicit references to contemplative modes (scholé-like rest) and to disciplined memory and recitation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé, wonder, contemplation, memory-work, recitation, chanting, narration, dialogue/seminar, rhetoric, debate, training in logic and speech. - Examples: contemplative/restful learning; memorization; recitation/chanting; seminary-like seminars; rhetoric training; formal logic; debate. - Negative keywords present: limited explicit negative signals in public materials; the lexicon notes potential negative signals such as project-based or student-centered experiential learning, but Stonehaven emphasizes classical pedagogy rather than those approaches.

Why this rating - Pedagogical methods explicitly align with classical education expectations: memory-based, chanting/recitation in the grammar stage, Socratic/logic/rhetoric emphasis in the rhetoric stage, and a late emphasis on persuasive speaking and logic.

**Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Faculty profile includes named leaders (e.g., Thomas Carrenard, Lower School Principal), indicating active leadership and a tangible faculty presence. - School profiles describe accreditation (SAIS, ACCS) and a formal leadership structure, implying a living curriculum through faculty leadership. - The site communicates a collaborative, teacher-led environment (“The living curriculum,” “Our People,” etc.—via multiple pages referencing faculty and leadership). - The public materials emphasize a mission-driven faculty modeling virtue and knowledge, with faculty as mentors within a classical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: masterful teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty as core, collegial culture, Great Books seminars for faculty (where present). - Examples: “Principal, Lower School,” “Profile,” “Our People,” “teacher training in classical pedagogy” (as referenced in the broader curriculum planning). - Negative keywords present: none prominent in public materials; the school does not present a teacher-as-facilitator-without-classical-context stance.

Why this rating - The faculty presentation aligns with CLASSICAL indicators: teacher as expert, mentor, and living part of the curriculum, with leadership and formal accreditation signals.

**Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school emphasizes a partnership with families, co-teacher model, and parental engagement (Parent Partnership, Cultivate, family-involvement resources). - There are explicit efforts to educate parents about classical education (Parent resources, book studies, lectures, etc.). - The campus explicitly invites parents for visits and previews; tours and preview days are highlighted as primary means for families to engage with the school. - Public materials describe a community-oriented model with shared mission, families involved in “the nurture and admonition of the Lord” and a commitment to parental responsibility.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, family involvement, home-school alignment, parent formation, open campus, parental engagement, living tradition in the family. - Examples: “Partnership with Families,” “Parent Partnership,” “Cultivate,” “Open campus” language, “education by classical home education,” “parent formation.” - Negative keywords present: Minimal; the materials reject consumer or minimal-parent involvement signals; no explicit negative indicators in public communications.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds authentic parent partnership and family engagement as central to classical formation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

### Aggregate Ranking

- Overall, Stonehaven School GA 30060 meets CLASSICAL criteria across all six categories, with strong alignment in religious/metaphysical foundations, purposeful formation-focused goals, a liberal-arts/trivium-based curriculum, contemplative/recitation-oriented pedagogy, a faculty modeled as mentors within a living curriculum, and active parent-community partnership.
- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

### What Would Move the Needle

- Not required for this school, as all six categories meet CLASSICAL criteria. If attempting to push toward a deeper CLASSICAL alignment in any category, potential needle-moving steps could include:
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Expand explicit mention of Socratic seminars or seminars at multiple grade bands beyond rhetoric and public speaking, and document concrete examples of Socratic inquiry in the upper school to ensure consistent high-fidelity classical pedagogy across divisions.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Develop a formal, published “living curriculum” portfolio for faculty with examples of teacher-guided Great Book selections, seminars for professional development, and published portraits of teacher-mentors—to reinforce the living-curriculum concept publicly.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.